



Interview with Ada Lovelace

Coding pioneer

In 1842, English mathematician Ada Lovelace became the world's first computer programmer. She is best known for her work on an early mechanical computer made by Charles Babbage. She helped to pave the way for the future of computers. This is an imaginary conversation with the clever countess.

Q: Ada, when did you find out you were good at math?

A: Very early on. Even as a child, I remember being good at solving mathematical problems.

Q: Do you come from a family of mathematical geniuses?

A: Not at all! However, my father was the celebrated poet, Lord Byron. I had tutors to teach me science and mathematics and although it was unusual for a young girl to learn these subjects, I soon found I was good at them.

Q: How did you meet computer genius Charles Babbage?

A: I was lucky enough to meet him in 1833 while he was teaching at Cambridge University in England.

FACT FILE

» **Name:** Augusta Ada King-Noel, Countess of Lovelace

» **Dates:** 1815–52

» **Location:** England

» **Fun fact:** When Ada was 12 years old, she tried to build a flying machine!

Watercolor portrait of Ada from 1840

